

Alcohol Scripts in the Workplace Worksheet

1. Identify a High-Risk Work Situation

Think of a specific moment where you feel the urge to drink.

Examples: after a long day, difficult meeting, happy hour, travel.

2. Notice the Alcohol Script

What automatic thought shows up? Check or add your own:

- ☐ “I deserve a drink after today”
- ☐ “This is how I unwind”
- ☐ “I can’t relax without it”
- ☐ “It would be awkward not to drink”
- ☐ “Just one won’t hurt”
- ☐ “Everyone else is doing it”
- ☐ Other: _____

3. Identify the Underlying Need

Pause and separate the urge from the need.

- ☐ Stress relief
- ☐ Emotional release
- ☐ Rest
- ☐ Connection
- ☐ Reward
- ☐ Escape
- ☐ Other: _____

4. Understand the Cycle

What happens when I follow this script and drink?

What are the short-term vs. longer-term effects?

5. Challenge the Script

Is drinking actually solving the problem?

What does past experience show?

What would support my goal of not drinking?

6. Create an Abstinence-Supporting Script

Replace the old thought with one aligned to your goal. *Examples: “Drinking won’t actually fix this—I need real rest” “This urge will pass, even if it’s uncomfortable” “I don’t drink, especially when I’m stressed” “I can unwind without alcohol.”*

My new script:

7. Plan a Replacement Action

Choose a specific, go-to alternative for that situation.

After work stress:

- ☐ Take a 10–15 minute decompression break (walk, music, silence)
- ☐ Shower or change environments to signal “work is done”

Social/work events:

- ☐ Bring/order a non-alcoholic drink immediately
- ☐ Prepare a simple response (“I don’t drink”)

Emotional overload:

- ☐ Call/text someone
- ☐ Journal or vent briefly

My replacement action: _____